"Community-based coalitions with a sustainable practical response and health care solution."

Introduction

The Health Reform Coalition (HRC), Reach Back Community Development Inc. (RBack) and **the International Cancer Alliance for Research and Education (iCare.org)** have joined forces to help faith-based organizations improve the health status of their congregations and local community. Our goal is to provide patients, families, doctors and advocates with information and expert assistance to make important decisions about living with cancer and chronic disease. We will raise awareness about and provide access to FDA-approved diagnostic and treatment options that are less costly, toxic and disruptive to patients and those providing and paying for their care.

For over 7 years, RBack and the HRC have been on the front lines researching and developing relationships and evidence-based solutions that improve health, save time and cut costs for healthcare delivery to vulnerable populations. **For more than 25 years**, working with leading researchers around the world, iCare has improved the quality and length of life of cancer patients across the nation. PHIERS.org will provide faith-based and public health advocacy programs with tailored health initiatives that meet the cultural, linguistic and literacy needs of an aging population living with cancer and chronic disease.

Together we have charted a plan of action consisting of research, collaboration, patient education, decision and caregiver support services. By combining people, process and technology, we believe that our upcoming demonstration project will improve outcomes and be 100% self-sustaining after the first year of operation.

What is PHIERS?

PHIERS (Public Health Intervention and Emergency Response Service), pronounced "fires", combines people, processes and technology to *transform and strengthen* the safety net, and bend the cost curve in the right direction.

Our methods have been proven to accelerate desired changes in human behavior, improving health, saving time and cutting cost for health care delivery to vulnerable populations.

What we do…

- **Raise awareness** about clinically-proven treatment options and screening processes to help patients and providers make better informed decisions
- **Facilitate better care transitions** and outcomes, by accelerating the use of Health/IT among vulnerable populations to reduce ER visits and readmissions
- **Expand access** to primary care support services through trusted anchor institutions and affordable expansion of the holistic health home (Triple-H)
- **Increase the quality, impact and reach** of effective interventions in targeted communities

Who benefits most and why?

- **Dual eligible and disabled persons with multiple chronic diseases and/or cancer** are the fastest growing and most costly health care consumers.
- **Patients and caregivers** need tools and support services to help them improve compliance, reduce ER visits and readmissions, and allow seniors to age at home with dignity, and as much as possible – independence.
- **Public health and social safety net facilities and Faith and community-based organizations** will be eligible for tax credits and grant partnerships to help fund the project's expansion in their local community.
- **Local, state and federal government agencies** will benefit from savings resulting from the above activities, which will help them prepare for, absorb and coordinate care for an aging population with unknown/unmanaged health needs.

Our innovative approach to health ministry outreach and community development can reinforce and track desired behaviors, and improve the quality of care transitions, compliance and outcomes. It is our goal to enable faith-based organizations to increase the impact of their health ministries and outreach programs on the local community, by making it easy to expand access to primary care support services where they're needed most. This will generate more in savings than it would cost to expand this pilot for additional communities. Evidence suggests that we will generate enough savings to expand the pilot into other communities, while creating thousands self-sustaining jobs between now and year-end (2014), without legislation, increasing taxes or cutting spending on programs important to our future.

Our Mission

Our mission is to provide a low cost, high impact and common sense approach to health reform success. Our focus is on *job creation*, *cost control, Health/IT and prevention*. Our methods to accomplish these goals include:

- **Connecting public health, faith and safety net organizations** in ways that accelerate and reinforce desired changes in human behavior, and generate savings to fund the project's expansion into communities where it's needed most.
- **Educating, empowering and inspiring** residents to become more responsible healthcare consumers, and in so doing strengthen the safety net they rely on.
- **Creating jobs that empower** front line health and social workers to be more effective at filling the informational and service-oriented needs of their clients and their families.
- **Making it easy** to tailor, manage and deploy health interventions locally, nationally and abroad – in an effective, sustainable and fiscally-responsible manner.

Our Roadmap to Health Reform Success

Step 1. Expand ICare's evidence-based 10 Step I-Team Process to the population at large. PHIERS.ORG will raise awareness about, and access to standard and alternative cancer treatments and screening options, while facilitating enrollment in FDA-approved clinical trials when appropriate/available. [**DONE**]

Step 2. Coordinate interventions with public health and social safety net organizations and local faith-based Health Ministry Programs. Tailor and deploy tools to track and improve the health status of their members. This will expand the patient-centered care team beyond clinicians to better serve the needs of the "whole person" while creating a patient-centered and holistic health home. [**In Process**]

Step 3. Conduct membership & fund raising drives. Invite public health and social safety net stakeholders to apply for grants and scholarships to expand their impact on the lives of local aging and disabled persons and caregivers. [**In Process**]

Step 4. Accelerate the use of Health/IT among vulnerable populations and safety net programs. We will provide tools to coordinate care across functionally-separate and multi-disciplinary care teams, proven to yield the best outcomes in the least amount of time for the lowest costs. [**Near future**]

Step 5. Provide government-funded programs with tools to securely track, analyze and share data about health outcomes across agencies. We will use Health/IT to help states prepare for the long term care crisis while making it easier to enforce accountability, and migrate from "fee-for-service" to "value-based" compensation.

Step 6. Create jobs for qualified local community members and unemployed health and social workers. We will expand the public health and social safety net in a sustainable way, while improving the health status of targeted communities.

Step 7. Assess the cost-benefit of our ongoing clinical trial and expand. Evidence suggests that participants will consume less costly health care than others with similar health issues. Each job created will deliver more in "savings" than it costs to sustain.

It is in this way that we will strengthen the safety net so States can coordinate care for an aging population with chronic health needs. This is a viable approach to the Long Term Care Crisis facing cities and states across the US.

Call to Action

We invite Safety Net programs, public health, faith and community-based organizations to participate in our pilot and fund-raising activities.

- **Registration is ongoing… with Open enrollment beginning on October 1, 2013**
- **Town Hall-style meetings and Webinars begin Fall 2013**
- **Our Clinical Trial and Pilot will launch before 2014**

For more information:

- **Patients and providers with cancer can register at www.icare.org**
- **Safety net providers & faith-based groups with health ministries / outreach programs can join the movement at www.phiers.org**
- **Contact us: info@phiers.org**

Participation is free and the benefits are unlimited!

We hope you will join and benefit from our upcoming demonstration project!

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